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POSING A CHALLENGE Rahul Gandhi and Tejashwi Yadav during the Voter Adhikar Yatra in Sasaram, Aug. 17

COMPETING PITCHES

NDA

12.1 mn women have got **Rs 10,000** each under the CM Mahila Rojgar Yojana

RJD-CONGRESS

Rs 2,500 social security pension

JAN SURAAJ

Proportionate representation for women in tickets/party posts; **Rs 2,000 a month** for 60-plus people, widows and specially-abled

X-FACTOR

YOUNG VOTERS

DEMOGRAPHIC SNAPSHOT

17 mn voters—around one-fourth of Bihar's electorate—in the 18–29 age group

BOOTH MATH

The cohort is some 70,000 strong per seat. Could decide close contests if they turn out, vote cohesively

POLITICAL SAVVY

Less anchored to old caste loyalties, but more susceptible to managed narratives/social media campaigns

NECK-AND-NECK

The BJP secured 42.6% of their vote and the RJD 39% in the constituencies they fought in 2020

Many in the youth cohort have no recollection of a time before the Nitish era

COMPETING PITCHES

NDA

10 mn jobs and 6,000 internships over the next 5 years; Rs 1,000 monthly for unemployed graduates for two years

RJD-CONGRESS

Assured government job for at least one member of every family

JAN SURAAJ

Accelerated roll-out of skill centres, vocational courses and guaranteed apprenticeships